Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - October 13, 2026

Compiled summary for Tuesday, October 13, 2026 - focus: continuing the portfolio refinement recorded through October 9; independently verifying the United States Eastern date; refreshing the repository snapshot; studying the full worklog archive; enlarging the compact and portrait landing-page profile treatment; consolidating the UI / UX Philosophy carousel around five color-matched keys and a rotating rounded star; rebuilding the My Core Beliefs centerpiece and bubble behavior; correcting bidirectional carousel motion; expanding My Workflow to five stages; adding harmonized gradients, deterministic star fields, and cutout masks; extending the shared color system into tab and philosophy typography; revising the philosophy copy; and validating the resulting responsive experience and repository state.

This worklog preserves the established project record structure: source materials reviewed, baseline status, goals, implementation grouped by feature, committed source sequence, validation, files and artifacts, follow-up notes, and the output artifact. It records completed work and observable repository evidence rather than speculative design intent.

Coverage begins after portfolio_worklog_october9.pdf and its documentation commit 92cebe9. Five implementation commits dated October 13 are present on main and origin/main, ending at 7e12b1517f6c8c123863374277ecfe6885f5f16a. No deployment was performed during this documentation pass. Apart from the generated PDF, the only documentation-side repository delta is the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt produced by the project reader.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date verification: an independent UTC-04:00 time query returned October 13, 2026 at 10:54:20 PM. A local TZ=America/New_York check independently returned Tuesday, October 13, 2026 at 22:54 EDT (-0400), confirming the correct Eastern calendar date and daylight-saving offset.
- Project reader: ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio. The script refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt to 19,565 lines and 653,515 bytes, providing the current consolidated source and repository context used for this record.
- Worklog archive: enumerated and extracted every pre-existing root-level PDF worklog, covering July 11 through October 9. The archive contains 52 PDFs, 299 pages, and approximately 148,796 extracted words. Titles, recurring section order, footer behavior, naming patterns, page density, and terminology were compared across the complete set.
- Nearest baselines: reviewed the October 9 worklog in full and compared its formatting and content density with the October 8 and September 29 Part 2 records, plus representative early and middle entries. The latest entries use a compact engineering narrative, evidence-rich bullets, committed-source chronology, validation detail, and explicit handoff notes.
- PDF conventions: US Letter portrait at 612 x 792 points; PDF 1.4; unencrypted; black text on white; Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold Type 1 fonts; a single dated title on page one; repeated footer title and right-aligned page number; compact margins; and document metadata identifying Codex as author, creator, and producer.
- Git history and diffs: inspected all five October 13 commits, their file lists, and the aggregate change since documentation commit 92cebe9. The source delta spans 21 files with 1,091 insertions and 154 deletions, including four TypeScript/CSS files, the snapshot, rounded-star assets, ten workflow star/mask assets, and the deterministic workflow-star generator.
- Runtime and responsive evidence: inspected the current application at desktop and compact widths, queried rendered DOM structure and computed styles, checked geometry and overflow, verified asset dimensions, ran the project checks, and exercised the primary routes.

Baseline Status Before October 13

- The October 9 baseline retained a larger philosophy content set and did not yet have the final five-key rotating-star relationship. The compact landing-page profile bubble and its name tag still used their earlier scale.
- My Core Beliefs already used five orbiting belief bubbles, but the centerpiece, color treatment, alignment, and active-bubble scaling had not yet been unified with the newer five-color visual language.
- The UI / UX Philosophy carousel still carried content that would be consolidated from stacks 06 and 07 into the five remaining stacks. Its left-navigation animation could diverge from right navigation because visual movement and logical face identity were not fully separated.
- My Workflow contained four stages. It lacked Release, five evenly ordered number/name tabs, the exact philosophy palette, star fields, and the foreground-cutout relationship introduced in this cycle.
- Workflow names and philosophy headers had not yet adopted the shared masked text gradients with black outlines, and the large philosophy-box copy still reflected the prior wording.

Goals for the October 13 Pass

- Increase the landing hero profile bubble and name tag by 20 percent in compact and portrait modes without disturbing the desktop composition.
- Create a five-point rounded-star system whose rotation and active opacity communicate the currently selected philosophy stack, while matching each key, header, and emphasis color.
- Reduce the philosophy carousel to five meaningful stacks by preserving and relocating the useful 06 and 07 content, then make both navigation directions visually consistent.
- Give My Core Beliefs a stable, responsive five-color centerpiece and make active bubbles enlarge equally around their own centers rather than drifting laterally.

- Expand My Workflow to Research, Plan, Produce, Analyze, and Release; distribute the five tabs evenly from left to right; and carry the shared palette into each stage.
- Layer subdued, varied star distributions into each workflow stage, including edge-clipped stars and intentional transparency cutouts, while keeping text and tabs legible.
- Unify workflow tab typography and philosophy emphasis typography with the key/star gradients, then replace the philosophy-box language with shorter, more decisive statements.

Work Completed - Landing Hero and Five-Key Philosophy System

- Raised the compact and portrait profile treatment to 1.2 times its previous scale so the portrait bubble and attached name tag retain more of their intended prominence on narrow layouts.
- Introduced custom rounded and rounded-gradient star artwork, moved the selected assets into the public image structure, and iterated scale and spacing until the philosophy star sat close to the large key without displacing the existing sentence or key positions.
- Mapped the five philosophy stacks to a stable visual order: 01 purple, 02 yellow, 03 blue, 04 orange, and 05 green. Key surfaces received subtle dark-ended gradients derived from the matching star points rather than flat fills.
- Applied the newest hollow rounded-star design to the UI / UX Philosophy section. The star rotates with carousel state so the downward-facing point corresponds to the selected key and header family.
- Restored explicit active/inactive emphasis for that section: the selected star point remains at full opacity while all non-active point zones render at 25 percent. The hollow center and newest artwork remain intact.
- Transferred the former 06 header and large-box material into stack 02, transferred the former 07 large-box material into stack 03, and removed stacks 06 and 07 from the visible content sequence. The result presents five keys while retaining the chosen content.

Work Completed - My Core Beliefs Star and Orbit

- Extended the five key gradients into the five belief bubbles as restrained border, glow, shadow, and interior shading accents. Yellow and orange were separated more clearly so adjacent warm hues remain distinguishable.
- Replaced the prior Core Beliefs centerpiece with the larger stylish five-color rounded star. The section uses the full-color version rather than the philosophy section's hollow active-point treatment.
- Protected the belief section from later philosophy-star changes by separating the two presentation rules: Core Beliefs keeps its complete stylish star, while UI / UX Philosophy independently applies carousel-driven opacity zones.
- Centered the star from the small-bubble geometry instead of from transient enlarged bounds. This keeps the visual center stable through all active-bubble positions and across responsive layouts.
- Changed active bubble magnification to expand equally in every direction around the bubble center. Enlarging a belief no longer biases the bubble toward the right or shifts the star/bubble relationship.
- Preserved the star's radial fade behavior so opacity falls with distance from the center toward the points, while avoiding the earlier hand-tuned zone boundaries that produced visible clipping and color bleed.

Work Completed - Bidirectional Philosophy Carousel Navigation

- Studied the earlier navigation repair and restored the identity-preserving face model after the left-navigation inconsistency returned during star and content revisions.
- Separated each mounted carousel face's stable identity from its temporary visual role. Faces now move through front, side, rear, and hidden staging positions without their content identity changing midway through the transition.
- Made previous and next navigation use mirrored state preparation and completion rules, including wraparound boundaries. Left navigation now follows the same apparent depth, timing, and content continuity as right navigation.
- Maintained six mounted visual roles as an animation implementation detail while presenting only the intended five content stacks. Hidden rear staging prevents an outgoing face from flashing or reappearing during wrap transitions.

Work Completed - Five-Stage Workflow Structure and Tabs

- Added stage 05, Release, to My Workflow. The complete left-to-right sequence is now 01 Research, 02 Plan, 03 Produce, 04 Analyze, and 05 Release.
- Reworked the responsive tab rail so 01 remains leftmost and 05 remains rightmost, with consistent distribution across the card. Number tabs and name tabs remain paired while allowing each name box to take the width required by its label.
- Expanded horizontal padding around the uppercase stage names after testing overly compact settings. The final treatment restores the larger readable type size while giving each label substantially more breathing room.
- Matched number and name tab backgrounds, borders, widths, color families, and opacity treatment to the UI / UX Philosophy number/header language. Borders remain deliberately fine and consistent with the surrounding system.
- Tuned name typography through several outline and fill experiments. The retained result uses original palette brightness expressed as per-stage masked gradients with a 2.0-pixel black text stroke, giving the labels definition without the glare of the discarded white outline.

Work Completed - Workflow Gradients, Star Fields, and Cutouts

- Applied the exact purple, yellow, blue, orange, and green philosophy key/star families to the upper gradient field of the corresponding workflow stages.
- Reoriented each field so its bright endpoint aligns horizontally with the active number/name tab and darkens gradually toward both left and right edges. Stop spacing was widened to make the transition extremely smooth.
- Set the workflow color-mask range from transparent dark endpoints to 33 percent at the bright tab-centered endpoint after comparing stronger 50 percent and 40 percent alternatives.
- Moved five monochrome source stars into the public workflow asset area and built a deterministic generator that produces both colored stars and transparent cutout masks for every palette family.
- Populated every workflow stage with 17 foreground stars and 17 corresponding cutout shapes. Larger stars cluster closer to the number/name tabs; progressively smaller and fewer stars occupy more distant zones.
- Varied the actual order, spacing, proximity, and placement map per stage rather than repeating one template. Collision constraints prevent stars from touching, while selected large stars intentionally clip through top, bottom, left, or right card edges for a less mechanical composition.
- Reduced overall star visibility through repeated passes so the field blends into the 0-to-33-percent background gradient. Reintroduced the poke-through effect only after the foreground contrast was subdued.
- Implemented the cutout layer as background-revealing transparency corresponding to each star rather than as conspicuous dark decals. The stars read as foreground texture while their transparent regions expose the field beneath.

Work Completed - Shared Typography and Philosophy Copy

- Applied the same per-color masked gradients and 2.0-pixel black strokes used by workflow stage names to the five UI / UX Philosophy header names.
- Extended those gradients and outlines to the oversized emphasized words inside the large philosophy boxes. Underline rules remain solid in each stack's assigned color because gradient underlines introduced visual awkwardness and weakened the hierarchy.
- Brightened the Research gradient endpoint slightly so the purple remains legible and balanced with the other four stage labels without abandoning the shared palette.
- Revised the User-friendly box to: Intuitive. Butter-Smooth. QUICKLY. Actionable.
- Revised the Responsive box to: Adaptable Between Form Factors. Scalable Between Device Types. NEVER. Cookie Cutter.
- Revised the Modern box to: Sleek. Streamlined. NEVER. Behind-the-times.
- Revised the Cohesive box to: Consistent. Interconnected. ALWAYS. Sensible.

Committed Source Sequence

- 4fefdf4 - Refined landing hero and UI/UX philosophy carousel. Enlarged compact profile treatment, introduced the rotating gradient star, remapped the five visual families, consolidated stacks 06 and 07, and added rounded-star assets.
- 0ea47fa - Refined philosophy stars and Core Beliefs interactions. Added the hollow active/inactive philosophy star, installed the stylish Core Beliefs star, carried key gradients into bubbles, and centered equal-direction bubble scaling.
- 9cd70c4 - Fixed bidirectional UI/UX philosophy carousel navigation. Stabilized face identity, added hidden rear staging, synchronized previous/next transitions, and corrected wrap behavior.
- 1e0320d - Expanded and polished five-stage workflow. Added Release, rebuilt the tab system, introduced exact key gradients and masked titles, added 17 stars and 17 cutouts per stage, and committed the deterministic generator.
- 7e12b15 - Refined UI/UX Philosophy typography and messaging. Applied shared gradients and black strokes to headers and emphasized words, retained solid underlines, and installed the revised box copy.

At documentation time, HEAD, main, and origin/main resolve to 7e12b1517f6c8c123863374277ecfe6885f5f16a. The five implementation commits are already committed and synchronized; this worklog pass itself has not created a commit or pushed any additional changes.

Validation Summary

- Project checks: npm run check completed successfully against the current source.
- Route checks: /, /projects/alla-vostra, /projects/cinerific, /aboutdev, and /articles each returned HTTP 200 from the local development server.
- Patch hygiene: git diff --check passed for the source-scoped implementation comparison. Repository status before PDF creation showed only the reader-refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt as modified.
- Desktop render at 1440 pixels: confirmed five workflow stages in the correct order; six mounted philosophy face roles supporting five content stacks; five Core Beliefs bubbles; the stylish Core Beliefs star source; 17 visible stars and 17 cutout stars per workflow stage; 2-pixel black strokes; computed masked linear gradients; solid stack-colored emphasis underlines; and zero horizontal overflow.
- Compact render at 390 pixels: document width matched viewport width exactly, the workflow tabs remained inside the card, and the five-stage ordering stayed intact.

- Intermediate render at 780 pixels: workflow tabs remained contained and correctly distributed. The document measured 809 pixels wide because of the intentionally oversized Core Beliefs image treatment, not because of the workflow rail.
- Asset checks: workflow star sources and generated masks are 2048 x 2048 pixels; the hollow philosophy star is 2052 x 2052 pixels. Current components reference the intended public assets.
- Console review found no functional application failure. A non-blocking Next Image largest-contentful-paint advisory appeared during one desktop inspection and does not alter interaction or layout behavior.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/page.tsx - compact hero scaling, workflow stage data, five-stage tab/content structure, and workflow star-field markup.
- app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx - five-stack content, stable carousel faces, rotating star state, header and large-box copy treatment.
- app/CoreBeliefsOrbit.tsx - stylish star source, centering geometry, active-bubble scaling, and belief color relationships.
- app/globals.css - responsive profile sizing, key gradients, carousel transforms, belief presentation, workflow fields and cutouts, tabs, masked typography, outlines, and underlines.
- public/images/uiux-philosophy-star-rounded-gradient.png, public/images/uiux-philosophy-star-rounded-stylish.png, public/images/uiux-philosophy-star-rounded-stylish-2.png, and public/images/uiux-philosophy-star-rounded-hollow.png - successive custom philosophy/Core Beliefs star assets retained for the established design sequence.
- public/images/workflow-star-{purple,yellow,blue,orange,green}.png and matching workflow-star-mask-* assets - five monochrome stage families plus their cutout masks.
- scripts/generate-workflow-star-assets.mjs - deterministic asset-generation path for reproducible workflow star and mask variants.
- star-rounded-full.png - root-level source artwork used during the star iteration and still present for future reference.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed project reader output created during this documentation pass.

Follow-Up Notes

- Treat the six mounted philosophy roles as a carousel implementation detail, not a return to six content stacks. Future changes should preserve stable face identity and mirrored transition preparation.
- Keep the star behaviors deliberately separate: UI / UX Philosophy uses the hollow rotating star with 100-percent active and 25-percent inactive point zones; My Core Beliefs keeps the full stylish star and radial fade.
- Preserve center-based transforms for belief bubbles. Any new scaling or focus animation should expand around each small-state bubble center so the star does not appear to wander.
- Workflow distributions are deterministic and intentionally different by stage. Regenerate them through scripts/generate-workflow-star-assets.mjs rather than manually replacing individual mask files.
- Workflow labels and philosophy emphasis depend on masked gradient text plus data-title or equivalent duplicate text for the black stroke. When editing labels, update the visible and stroked text paths together.
- Keep philosophy underlines solid unless a new treatment is evaluated in context; the gradient text experiment did not translate cleanly to thin rules.
- If visual changes appear stale locally, clear the Next development cache and restart the server before evaluating the CSS or asset result.
- Before any later commit or push, review the refreshed snapshot and this PDF as documentation-only changes and prepare a past-tense commit message that distinguishes them from the five completed source commits.

Output Artifact

- Generated /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october13.pdf using the established non-zero-padded, lowercase-month naming convention for the first worklog recorded on a date.
- The artifact is a US Letter, portrait, PDF 1.4 document using Helvetica/Helvetica-Bold, compact black-on-white engineering-report styling, repeated dated footers, page numbers, and Codex document metadata consistent with the latest archive entries.
- The recorded implementation baseline is 7e12b1517f6c8c123863374277ecfe6885f5f16a on synchronized main and origin/main. No source edit, commit, push, or deployment was performed while producing this documentation artifact.
- Documentation deltas produced by this pass are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and portfolio_worklog_october13.pdf.